Environment.SpecialFolder Enum

Definition

Namespace: System

Assemblies: netstandard.dll, System.Runtime.dll

Source: Environment.SpecialFolder.cs

Specifies enumerated Constant Special Item ID List (CSIDL) values used to retrieve directory paths to system special folders.

C#

```
public enum Environment.SpecialFolder
```

Inheritance Object → ValueType → Enum → Environment.SpecialFolder

Fields

Expand table

Name	Value	Description
Desktop	0	The logical Desktop rather than the physical file system location.
Programs	2	The directory that contains the user's program groups.
MyDocuments	5	The **My Documents** folder. This member is equivalent to Personal.
Personal	5	The directory that serves as a common repository for documents. This member is equivalent to MyDocuments.
Favorites	6	The directory that serves as a common repository for the user's favorite items.
Startup	7	The directory that corresponds to the user's Startup program group. The system starts these programs whenever a user logs on or starts Windows.
Recent	8	The directory that contains the user's most recently used documents.

Name	Value	Description
SendTo	9	The directory that contains the Send To menu items.
StartMenu	11	The directory that contains the Start menu items.
MyMusic	13	The **My Music** folder.
MyVideos	14	The file system directory that serves as a repository for videos that belong to a user.
DesktopDirectory	16	The directory used to physically store file objects on the desktop. Do not confuse this directory with the desktop folder itself, which is a virtual folder.
MyComputer	17	The **My Computer** folder. When passed to the `Environment.GetFolderPath` method, the `MyComputer` enumeration member always yields the empty string ("") because no path is defined for the My Computer folder.
NetworkShortcuts	19	A file system directory that contains the link objects that may exist in the **My Network Places** virtual folder.
Fonts	20	A virtual folder that contains fonts.
Templates	21	The directory that serves as a common repository for document templates.
CommonStartMenu	22	The file system directory that contains the programs and folders that appear on the **Start** menu for all users.
CommonPrograms	23	A folder for components that are shared across applications.
CommonStartup	24	The file system directory that contains the programs that appear in the **Startup** folder for all users.
CommonDesktopDirectory	25	The file system directory that contains files and folders that appear on the desktop for all users.
ApplicationData	26	The directory that serves as a common repository for application-specific data for the current roaming user. A roaming user works on more than one computer on a network. A roaming user's profile is kept on a server on the network and is loaded onto a system when the user logs on.
PrinterShortcuts	27	The file system directory that contains the link objects that can exist in the **Printers** virtual folder.

Name	Value	Description
LocalApplicationData	28	The directory that serves as a common repository for application-specific data that is used by the current, non-roaming user.
InternetCache	32	The directory that serves as a common repository for temporary Internet files.
Cookies	33	The directory that serves as a common repository for Internet cookies.
History	34	The directory that serves as a common repository for Internet history items.
CommonApplicationData	35	The directory that serves as a common repository for application-specific data that is used by all users.
Windows	36	The Windows directory or SYSROOT. This corresponds to the %windir% or %SYSTEMROOT% environment variables.
System	37	The System directory.
ProgramFiles	38	The program files directory. In a non-x86 process, passing ProgramFiles to the GetFolderPath(Environment+SpecialFolder) method returns the path for non-x86 programs. To get the x86 program files directory in a non-x86 process, use the ProgramFilesX86 member.
MyPictures	39	The **My Pictures** folder.
UserProfile	40	The user's profile folder. Applications should not create files or folders at this level; they should put their data under the locations referred to by ApplicationData.
SystemX86	41	The Windows **System** folder.
ProgramFilesX86	42	The x86 **Program Files** folder.
CommonProgramFiles	43	The directory for components that are shared across applications. To get the x86 common program files directory in a non-x86 process, use the ProgramFilesX86 member.
CommonProgramFilesX86	44	The **Program Files** folder.
CommonTemplates	45	The file system directory that contains the templates that are available to all users.

Name	Value	Description
CommonDocuments	46	The file system directory that contains documents that are common to all users.
CommonAdminTools	47	The file system directory that contains administrative tools for all users of the computer.
AdminTools	48	The file system directory that is used to store administrative tools for an individual user. The Microsoft Management Console (MMC) will save customized consoles to this directory, and it will roam with the user.
CommonMusic	53	The file system directory that serves as a repository for music files common to all users.
CommonPictures	54	The file system directory that serves as a repository for image files common to all users.
CommonVideos	55	The file system directory that serves as a repository for video files common to all users.
Resources	56	The file system directory that contains resource data.
LocalizedResources	57	The file system directory that contains localized resource data.
CommonOemLinks	58	This value is recognized in Windows Vista for backward compatibility, but the special folder itself is no longer used.
CDBurning	59	The file system directory that acts as a staging area for files waiting to be written to a CD.

Examples

The following example shows how to use Environment.SpecialFolder with the Environment.GetFolderPath method to get the System directory.

C#

```
// Sample for the Environment.GetFolderPath method
using System;

class Sample
{
    public static void Main()
    {
    Console.WriteLine();
```

```
    Console.WriteLine("GetFolderPath: {0}",
                Environment.GetFolderPath(Environment.SpecialFolder.System));
    }
}
/*
This example produces the following results:

GetFolderPath: C:\WINNT\System32
*/
```

Remarks

The system special folders are folders such as **Program Files**, **Programs**, **System**, or **Startup**, which contain common information. Special folders are set by default by the system, or explicitly by the user, when installing a version of Windows.

The Environment.GetFolderPath method returns the locations associated with this enumeration. The locations of these folders can have different values on different operating systems, the user can change some of the locations, and the locations are localized.

For more information about special folders, see the KNOWNFOLDERID constants in the Windows documentation.

Applies to

Product	Versions
.NET	Core 2.0, Core 2.1, Core 2.2, Core 3.0, Core 3.1, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11
.NET Framework	1.1, 2.0, 3.0, 3.5, 4.0, 4.5, 4.5.1, 4.5.2, 4.6, 4.6.1, 4.6.2, 4.7, 4.7.1, 4.7.2, 4.8, 4.8.1
.NET Standard	2.0, 2.1